STUDIO NPV · BRAND GUIDELINES · V2.1 · OCTOBER 2026

Indigo & *Marigold*

Indigo is the oldest dye India gave the world: deep, steady and trustworthy. Marigold is the colour of beginnings: warm, local and impossible to ignore. Together they say a senior builder from Bengaluru who is good company.

classy on the page, fun in the margin

01 · IDEA

A page, and a *margin*

Founders hiring a solo builder ask two things: can I trust this person with my idea, and will working with them feel human? The page answers the first with structure, real numbers, fixed prices and strong colour blocks. The margin answers the second with pen notes in vermilion red and marigold circles, like someone marked up your plan.

The brand tells the story of a project: napkin, then scope, then shipped. The hand is loudest at the start and quietest at the end. Finished things look finished.

02 · COLOUR

The palette

Two brand colours, one pen, three neutrals. Every text pairing below passes WCAG AA (4.5:1) and was checked.

Indigo

White text 12.0:1

Indigo #232C82

Hero and contact bands, primary buttons, numbers

Marigold

Deep Indigo text 8.9:1

Marigold #F5B53F

Buttons on indigo, pen circles, active states

Vermilion

On Paper 4.6:1

Vermilion #C2401E

Handwritten notes, strike-throughs, low scores

Deep Indigo

White text 16.1:1

Deep indigo #161B4F

Footer, text on marigold

Paper

Ink text 15.2:1

Paper #F4F2EC

The page background

Turmeric

Ink text 14.3:1

Turmeric wash #FCE9C2

Warm bands, asides, pills

Ink

On Paper 15.2:1

Ink #171A33

Body text and headlines

Slate

On Paper 6.0:1

Slate #555A78

Secondary text, labels

PROPORTION ACROSS A PAGE



~50% Paper · ~25% Indigo bands · ~12% Turmeric · Ink text · Marigold as accent · Vermilion only in the margin

TURMERIC BAND

For proof and next steps

notes in vermilion

DARK SCHEME

Every pairing has a dark version: see Light and dark, next.

04 · SCHEMES

Light and *dark*

Every screen ships in both schemes, because not everyone likes a dark background, and not everyone likes a bright one. Pages follow the device's setting until someone chooses; a round sun and moon button in the header switches scheme, and the choice is remembered. Try it at the top right of this page.

The type, marks, layout and voice stay the same. Only the colour of each role changes: in the dark scheme, marigold takes over as the accent and the button, and the notes use a lighter vermilion.

LIGHT SCHEME

studio *npv*

Ink text, *accent word*

Secondary text for labels and notes

A card on the page

An indigo band, *marigold accent*

Primary button → *a margin note*

DARK SCHEME

studio *npv*

Ink text, *accent word*

Secondary text for labels and notes

A card on the page

An indigo band, *marigold accent*

Primary button → *a margin note*

THE DARK PALETTE

Night

Mist text 15.6:1

Night #10143A

The page background in the dark scheme

Night card

Mist text 13.7:1

Night card #1A1F4D

Cards, panels and fields

Mist

On Night 15.6:1

Mist #EEF0FB

Body text and headlines

Haze

On Night 8.7:1

Haze #AEB3D8

Secondary text, labels

Night indigo

White text 14.0:1

Night indigo #1C2468

Hero and contact bands

Night turmeric

Mist text 12.7:1

Night turmeric #2A2547

Warm bands, asides, pills

Midnight

Mist text 16.7:1

Midnight #0B0E2A

The footer

Light vermilion

On Night 7.9:1

Light vermilion #FF8F6B

Margin notes and corrections

RULE

Every pairing in both schemes passes WCAG AA (4.5:1). Print and documents use the light scheme; screens offer both.

05 · WORDMARK

The wordmark







studio *npv*

CONSTRUCTION	“studio” in Instrument Sans Medium; “npv” in Instrument Serif Italic at 1.35× the size, on a shared baseline, in the accent colour of its background. Lowercase, always.
NEVER	Never drawn by hand, circled, or set in Kalam. The wordmark belongs to the page, not the margin.

06 · TYPE

Three voices, three typefaces

DISPLAY · INSTRUMENT SERIF	Software people *use*.
USE	Headlines, big numbers, step numerals, FAQ questions, post titles. The italic word takes the accent colour. Never below 22px.
PAGE · INSTRUMENT SANS	I design and build software for founders and small businesses, for a fixed price agreed before work starts.
USE	Body 17/1.6, small 14–15, labels 12 uppercase at 0.1em tracking. Every button, field and nav item.
MARGIN · KALAM LIGHT	*the price is set here, once*

USE	Margin notes only: vermilion on Paper, marigold on Indigo, 18–24px, one short line.

07 · THE MARGIN

Four pen marks, used *sparingly*

This is the whole budget for fun. One mark per screen view. If a mark doesn't point at something true and specific, delete it.

CIRCLE · MARIGOLD

From a napkin sketch

For the one word a page is about. Hero headlines only.

UNDERLINE · MARIGOLD

One fixed price

For a promise. One section heading per page.

MARGIN NOTE · VERMILION

a few lines is enough to start

An aside in your voice, beside what it explains. Under eight words.

CORRECTION · VERMILION

~~hourly billing~~

For what the studio doesn't do, or what waits until later. Rare.

MOTION	Circles and underlines draw on once, 900ms. Nothing loops. With reduced motion turned on they're simply there. Marks are absolutely positioned, so they never shift layout.

08 · CONTROLS

Buttons, links and fields

Controls belong to the page, never the margin: round, exact, never drawn. Primary is Indigo on Paper and Marigold on Indigo; hover swaps to the other brand colour.

Tell me about your idea →

Secondary action

Text link →

On an Indigo band →

Text link →

SIZES

48px tall pills (44px minimum touch target), 24px side padding, Instrument Sans Medium 15px, optional →. One primary per view. Links get a 1.5px marigold underline.

Field label

12px radius, 50px tall

Focus: Indigo border plus a 3px Turmeric ring. Labels always visible above the field.

09 · LAYOUT

Rhythm and colour blocks

PAGE RHYTHM

Indigo hero → Paper sections → a Turmeric band for proof → Paper → Indigo contact band → Deep Indigo footer. Every page opens on a colour block, and no stretch of plain paper runs longer than about two screens.

SPACING

8px base. Sections 72px apart on desktop, 48px on phones. A 200px label rail on desktop; everything stacks at phone width with a 20px gutter.

SURFACES	White cards with a 1px border and 16px radius for grouped items. Panels sitting on Indigo (forms, the product demo) get a soft deep shadow. 999px radius for buttons.
IMAGERY	One real portrait, ideally on a marigold or indigo backdrop. No stock photos, no illustrated people, no gradients or glows.
UI LIBRARY PICKS	Accordion (shadcn) for FAQs · Sheet (shadcn) for the phone menu · Stateful Button (Aceternity) for forms · Timeline (Aceternity), static, on About.

10 · VOICE

How it sounds

Plain, direct, first person. Say what it costs and what you get; skip what you are.

PERSON	“I design and build…”	not “We craft bespoke digital experiences”
PRICE	“a fixed price agreed before work starts”	not “affordable packages”
PROOF	“$6.4M documented cost impact”	not “proven track record”
LIMITS	“If you need very large scale from day one, I’ll say so.”	not “No project too big or small”
MARGIN	*the price is set here, once*	not jokes, emoji or exclamation marks

11 · CHECKS

Do and don’t

DO

- Open every page on an Indigo block
- Use one pen mark per view, pointing at something true
- Keep finished UI crisp; the hand belongs to drafts and notes
- Ship both schemes, with the sun / moon toggle in the header
- Check every page in light, in dark, and at 390px

DON'T

- Draw buttons, fields or the wordmark by hand
- Put marigold text on Paper (it fails contrast)
- Add gradients, glows, emoji or stock imagery
- Animate anything that loops or follows the cursor

made by hand in Bengaluru